DigitalOcean Deployment Plan for Laravel + MySQL

0) Create the Droplet

- Plan: Basic $6/month (1 GB RAM, 1 vCPU).
- Image: Ubuntu 22.04 LTS.
- Auth: SSH key preferred.
- Add Monitoring. Create.

1) First login and base hardening

ssh root@YOUR_DROPLET_IP

adduser deploy

usermod -aG sudo deploy

ufw allow OpenSSH

ufw allow "Nginx Full"

ufw --force enable

apt update && apt -y upgrade

fallocate -l 1G /swapfile

chmod 600 /swapfile

mkswap /swapfile

swapon /swapfile

echo '/swapfile none swap sw 0 0' >> /etc/fstab

2) Install Nginx, PHP, MySQL, Composer, Git

sudo apt install -y nginx mysql-server php-fpm php-cli php-mysql php-xml php-mbstring php-curl php-zip php-gd unzip git composer

3) Secure and set up MySQL

sudo mysql_secure_installation

CREATE DATABASE laravel_db CHARACTER SET utf8mb4 COLLATE utf8mb4_unicode_ci;

CREATE USER 'laravel_user'@'localhost' IDENTIFIED BY 'STRONG_PASSWORD';

GRANT ALL PRIVILEGES ON laravel_db.* TO 'laravel_user'@'localhost';

FLUSH PRIVILEGES;

4) Deploy Laravel

Upload repo or code to /var/www/app

composer install --no-dev --optimize-autoloader

cp .env.example .env

php artisan key:generate

5) Permissions

sudo chown -R www-data:www-data storage bootstrap/cache

sudo chmod -R 775 storage bootstrap/cache

6) Nginx Virtual Host

Configure /etc/nginx/sites-available/laravel

root /var/www/app/public;

fastcgi_pass unix:/run/php/php8.1-fpm.sock;

Enable site and reload nginx

7) Point domain to Droplet IP

8) Enable HTTPS

sudo certbot --nginx -d yourdomain.com -d www.yourdomain.com

9) Optimize Laravel

php artisan config:cache

php artisan route:cache

php artisan view:cache

10) Scheduler and Queues (if used)

Set cron for schedule:run

Systemd service for queue:work

11) Backups and Updates

mysqldump -u root -p laravel_db > backup.sql

sudo apt update && sudo apt -y upgrade